BONUS 6

Recommended Equipment List

What to buy first, what can wait



In this guide

How to Use This Guide

1. Clippers

2. Trimmers and Detailers

3. Shavers and Foil Shavers

4. Guards (Attachment Combs)

5. Straight Razors, Shavettes and Blades

6. Scissors and Shears

7. Combs

8. Brushes

9. Capes, Neck Strips and Neck Covers

10. Spray Bottle

11. Clipper Oil and Cleaner

12. Disinfectant

13. Aftershave and Styling Basics

14. Mirrors

15. Chair and Station

16. Mannequin Head for Practice

17. Gloves

18. Towels and Hot Towel Setup

19. Lighting

The Starter Kit Checklist

Intermediate Kit

Pro Kit

How to Maintain and Disinfect Your Tools

How to Buy Used Equipment

Suggested Budget by Stage

Shopping Checklist

Next step

> *Good tools do not make a barber, but bad or dirty tools will hold one back. This guide walks through every category of equipment you will meet in a barbershop, explains what it is, what it is for and what to look for, and sorts options into three levels: **starter**, **better** and **pro**. We describe tool types, never brands, so you can shop anywhere.*

> **About prices**
> Every price in this guide is a rough range marked 'around'. Prices vary by country, store, season and quality, so treat them as planning numbers, not quotes.

> **Safety and licensing first**
> Sanitation comes before shopping. Plan for disinfectant, clean towels and single-use blades from day one. In many places you also need a barber or cosmetology license to work on paying clients, and the rules about which tools you may use vary. Check your local licensing requirements. Your Certificate of Completion is not a license.

How to Use This Guide

Read the categories in order the first time, then use the starter kit checklist and the budget section to decide what to buy now and what can wait. The three levels mean this:

- **Starter:** reliable and affordable, enough to learn every technique in the course.
- **Better:** more power, longer life and finer control; a sensible upgrade once you cut regularly.
- **Pro:** built for all-day daily use, with the best motors, steel and ergonomics.

You do not need pro gear to learn. Most beginners progress faster with a small, clean, well-maintained kit than with a big expensive one.

1. Clippers

Clippers are the engine of barbering. They cut hair with a moving blade that slides across a fixed blade, and they do most of the work in fades, tapers and buzz cuts. Learn on one dependable pair before collecting several.

Corded clippers

A corded clipper plugs into the wall. It never runs out of battery, and its motor tends to keep steady power through thick, wet or coarse hair. The cord can limit movement, so look for a long, flexible cord.

- **Good for:** heavy bulk removal, long days, thick hair, consistent power.
- **What to look for:** a motor that does not bog down in thick hair, an adjustable or interchangeable blade, comfortable weight and balance, a cord of around 8 feet or more, and available replacement blades.

- **Starter:** a basic corded clipper with a standard blade and a set of guards, around the low end of the price range.
- **Better:** a stronger magnetic or rotary motor with a tighter, sharper blade, often a few times the starter price.
- **Pro:** a heavy-duty motor, precision-ground steel blade and long service life, often several times the starter price.

Cordless clippers

A cordless clipper runs on a rechargeable battery. It gives you freedom to move around the head and is easy to use for detail and fade work. The tradeoffs are battery life and, in cheaper models, less power.

- **Good for:** fades, mobility, mobile or home setups, quick touch-ups.
- **What to look for:** at least 90 minutes of runtime, a fast charge, a swappable or easily replaced battery, a charge stand, and a runtime indicator.
- **Starter:** an entry-level cordless with moderate runtime and a basic blade.
- **Better:** longer runtime, a stronger motor and a more precise blade.
- **Pro:** corded-level power with all-day runtime and a swappable battery.

> **Which first?**
> If you can only buy one, a reliable corded clipper is the most forgiving way to learn. Add a cordless once you are comfortable with fades and want to move around the chair more freely.

2. Trimmers and Detailers

A trimmer is a small clipper with a narrow, close-cutting blade. It draws crisp lines at the hairline, neckline, beard edges and around the ears. A detailer is a trimmer with an even finer, often T-shaped blade for sharp outlines, parts and designs.

- **What to look for:** a blade that can be zeroed or adjusted so teeth sit very close, a comfortable pen-style grip, low vibration and noise, and a charge stand if cordless.
- **Starter:** a basic trimmer with an adjustable blade, around the low price range.
- **Better:** a stronger motor and a finer, sharper blade that keeps clean lines on coarse hair.
- **Pro:** a T-blade detailer with excellent edge control; many barbers own two so one is always ready.

For edge-ups and designs, practice with the blade slightly open or zero-gapped as your teacher shows in the lessons, and always keep the blades oiled.

3. Shavers and Foil Shavers

A foil shaver cuts through a thin perforated metal screen, giving a very close, smooth finish with little risk of nicks. Barbers use it to clean up fades, necklines, bald heads and beard edges when they want a smooth result without a blade.

- **Good for:** skin fades, shaving bald heads, clean necklines, sensitive skin.
- **What to look for:** a foil that is easy to replace, a cutter block that stays sharp, a cordless option with a decent runtime, and a rinse-friendly design.
- **Starter:** a compact foil shaver at a modest price.
- **Better:** a stronger motor and a finer foil for a closer finish.
- **Pro:** a precision foil built for daily professional use, with replaceable foils and cutters.

> **Foil care**
>
> The foil is thin and dents easily. Never press hard, never drop it, and replace the foil and cutters on schedule. A damaged foil can pinch or irritate skin.

4. Guards (Attachment Combs)

Guards clip onto a clipper blade and set the length of hair left behind. They are numbered, with each number equal to a length in eighths of an inch: a #1 leaves about 1/8 in, a #2 about 1/4 in, a #4 about 1/2 in, a #8 about 1 in. Always buy a complete set, because skipping a number makes blending much harder.

GUARD	APPROX. LENGTH (IN)	APPROX. LENGTH (MM)
#0.5 (if included)	1/16	about 1.5
#1	1/8	about 3
#2	1/4	about 6
#3	3/8	about 10
#4	1/2	about 13
#5	5/8	about 16
#6	3/4	about 19
#7	7/8	about 22
#8	1	about 25

- **What to look for:** a full set from #1 to #8, guards that fit your clipper snugly without wobbling, stiff plastic that does not flex, and clearly printed numbers.
- **Starter:** the set that comes with your clipper, plus a spare set if possible.
- **Better:** a universal or magnetic set with firm teeth and clear numbering.
- **Pro:** a full, matched set plus extra copies of the most used sizes (#1, #2, #3), and a few spare for sanitizing between clients.

Guard sizes are not perfectly standard from one maker to another, so measure the first few cuts against a ruler or the clipper manual until you know your own set.

5. Straight Razors, Shavettes and Blades

A straight razor or shavette is used for the closest shave on the neckline, beard and bald head, and for sharp lines. A shavette holds a replaceable single-use blade; a traditional straight razor has a fixed blade that must be honed and stropped.

- **Good for:** crisp outlines, neck shaves, beard lines, bald fades, skin fades.
- **What to look for:** a handle with a firm blade lock, an ergonomic grip, blades that fit securely, and a smooth finish with no rough spots.
- **Starter:** a basic shavette with disposable blades; the safest way to learn because each client gets a fresh blade.
- **Better:** a sturdier shavette with a precise blade lock and better balance.
- **Pro:** a high-quality shavette or, for advanced barbers, a traditional straight razor with proper honing and stropping skills.

> **Single-use blades are non-negotiable**
>
> Use a new blade for every client and dispose of used blades safely in a rigid, puncture-proof sharps container. Never reuse a blade between people. Many regions also have specific rules for razor work, so check your local requirements.

Take your time with razor work. Practice the strokes on a practice head or a prepared surface and in the lessons first. Skin that is stretched flat, lathered and well lit is far safer to shave.

6. Scissors and Shears

Cutting shears

Cutting scissors have two sharp, straight blades and are used for scissor-over-comb work, length control, tapering and detail. They are the main tool for classic scissor cuts.

- **Size:** around 5.5 to 6.5 inches is common; shorter for control, longer for sweeping cuts.
- **What to look for:** a sharp, smooth cutting edge, a comfortable handle, a tension screw you can adjust, and a finger rest or removable finger insert.
- **Starter:** a sturdy, basic stainless-steel pair, around the low end of the range.
- **Better:** a pair with harder steel, better balance and a convex edge, a few times the starter price.
- **Pro:** premium Japanese-style or similar high-hardness steel with a razor-sharp convex edge; often many times the starter price.

Thinning and texturizing shears

Thinning shears have a toothed blade that removes bulk, while texturizing shears have wider teeth for blending and adding movement. They soften heavy lines and remove weight without changing the overall length.

- **What to look for:** the tooth count and spacing printed on the blade, since fewer wide teeth remove more hair; a smooth cutting action; matching quality to your cutting shears.
- **Starter:** one basic thinner with a medium tooth count.
- **Better:** a pair with finer teeth for smoother blending.
- **Pro:** two or three styles, for example a blender, a chunker and a finishing thinner.

> **Scissor care**
>
> Keep scissors dry, oiled lightly, in a case, and never use them on anything but hair. Dropping them can ruin the alignment. Have them sharpened by a professional rather than doing it yourself.

7. Combs

Combs control the hair for clippers and scissors. You will use several kinds, and each has a specific job.

COMB	WHAT IT DOES	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
Barber comb	Tapers from fine to coarse teeth; used for scissor-over-comb and clipper-over-comb work	Flexible, heat-resistant material, fine teeth at one end, a straight, even spine
Flat top comb	Has a long, level edge that lets you cut a perfectly flat surface	A long, rigid, flat spine and evenly spaced teeth
Fade comb	Short, tapered comb that guides the clipper close to the head during blending	Thin, flexible teeth and a slim body that sits close to the scalp
Wide-tooth comb	Detangling and working product through longer hair	Smooth, seamless teeth that do not snag
Styling/finish comb	Final parting and styling	A comfortable handle and fine, even teeth

- **Starter:** one barber comb, one fade comb and a flat top comb; they cost very little.
- **Better:** carbon or anti-static combs that resist heat and static.
- **Pro:** a rack of each type, so you can swap to a freshly sanitized comb between clients.

8. Brushes

- **Neck duster:** a soft, wide brush with natural or synthetic bristles that sweeps loose hair from the neck and face. Look for soft bristles and a comfortable handle; a softer brush is more comfortable for clients.
- **Shaving brush:** used to lather soap, cream or foam for razor work. Look for dense bristles that hold water and a handle that grips well when wet.
- **Fade brush:** a slim, stiff-yet-soft brush used to lift hair off the skin during a fade so you can see the blend. Look for a tapered shape and bristles that clear hair easily.

Starter brushes are cheap and fine to learn with. Better and pro brushes use denser bristles that last longer and feel nicer on the skin. Wash brushes regularly and let them dry fully.

9. Capes, Neck Strips and Neck Covers

A cape protects the client's clothing from hair and chemicals. A neck strip, a paper or fabric band, sits between the cape and the skin, keeping hair away from the neck.

- **What to look for in a cape:** a smooth, non-clinging fabric that sheds hair easily, an adjustable snap or velcro closure, and a size that covers the client fully.
- **Neck strips:** disposable paper strips are the easy hygienic choice; some use reusable cloth strips that must be washed.
- **Starter:** one cape and a roll of disposable neck strips.
- **Better:** two capes so one is always clean, and a lightweight chemical-resistant cape for color work.
- **Pro:** several capes in rotation, sorted by use: cutting, color and shaving.

> **Wash between clients**
> Hair clings to capes and can carry skin cells and oils. Shake out, wipe or wash capes regularly according to your local rules, and use a fresh neck strip for every client.

10. Spray Bottle

A spray bottle dampens hair for scissor work and keeps it manageable. A fine mist is better than a stream, since you want even moisture without soaking the hair or the client's clothes.

- **What to look for:** a bottle with a fine, continuous mist, a trigger that does not leak, and a size you can hold comfortably.
- **Starter:** a basic bottle, plain water only.
- **Better:** a continuous-mist bottle that sprays at any angle.
- **Pro:** labeled separate bottles for water and any disinfectant so they are never mixed up.

> **Label everything**
> Never put disinfectant or other products in an unlabeled bottle. Mark each container clearly with what it holds.

11. Clipper Oil and Cleaner

Clipper blades run against each other at high speed. Oil reduces friction and heat, and blade cleaner or spray removes hair and residue so the blades cut cleanly. Both extend the life of your equipment.

- **Clipper oil:** a light mineral-based oil made for clipper blades. A few drops across the blade before each use or between clients is the norm.

- **Blade wash or cleaner spray:** a liquid or spray that dissolves hair, oil and residue and helps keep blades sanitary.
- **Cleaning brush:** a small stiff brush to clear hair out of the blade and clipper housing.
- **Starter:** one small bottle of oil and a cleaning brush.
- **Better:** add a blade spray or wash and a dedicated blade-cleaning dish.
- **Pro:** bulk oil, a blade-cleaning station, and a spare set of blades for rotation.

The Equipment Care module in the course shows how to clean and oil your clippers and change a ceramic blade step by step. Follow the manufacturer's instructions for your specific tool.

12. Disinfectant

Disinfecting between clients protects both of you. Choose products intended for salon and barber tools, and always follow the label.

- **Hospital-grade or salon-grade disinfectant:** look for a label that states it kills bacteria, viruses and fungi, and note the required contact time.
- **Disinfecting container:** a lidded jar or tub for soaking combs, shears and non-electrical tools for the required time.
- **Disinfecting spray or wipes:** for quickly wiping clippers, trimmers and surfaces, following the label directions.
- **Starter:** one labeled disinfectant spray and a small soak container.
- **Better:** a spray, wipes and a larger soak tub so you can rotate tools.
- **Pro:** a full sanitation station with duplicate tools so one set is always clean and ready.

> **Clean first, then disinfect**
>
> Disinfectant works on clean surfaces. Remove hair and debris, wash with soap and water if needed, then disinfect for the full contact time on the label. Rinse and dry tools as directed.

> **Know your local rules**
>
> Many places have specific sanitation requirements for barbershops, including approved disinfectants and tool storage. Check your local requirements.

13. Aftershave and Styling Basics

You do not need an entire wall of product. A few basics let you finish a cut properly and teach clients what works for their hair.

- **Aftershave or soothing lotion:** calms the skin after razor and trimmer work. Choose gentle, fragrance-light options, and ask clients about sensitivities first.
- **Pomade:** a classic styling product that adds shine and hold, from light to strong.

- **Clay or paste:** a matte finish with medium to strong hold, for texture and volume.
- **Styling powder:** adds grip and volume to fine hair with a dry, natural finish.
- **Shaving cream, gel or soap:** a slick lather for razor work.

For a starter kit, one aftershave, one shaving cream and one all-around styling product are enough. Test any product on yourself or a willing friend before using it on clients, and watch for allergies and skin reactions.

14. Mirrors

Clients should see what you are doing, and you need to see the back of the head. A good mirror setup helps you check symmetry and balance.

- **Wall mirror:** a large mirror at the station so the client sees the front.
- **Hand mirror:** shows the client the back and sides at the end of the service.
- **What to look for:** a shatter-resistant surface, clear glass with no distortion, and good lighting nearby.
- **Starter:** a standard hand mirror and whatever wall mirror you have.
- **Better:** a large, well-lit wall mirror and a sturdy hand mirror.
- **Pro:** a professional station mirror with built-in lighting.

15. Chair and Station

If you are learning at home, a sturdy stool or kitchen chair at a good height works. A true barber chair is a significant purchase, so treat it as a later upgrade.

- **Barber chair:** hydraulic height adjustment, a stable base, a headrest, a footrest and easy-to-clean upholstery. Check the weight limit and that it rotates smoothly.
- **Station or work surface:** a clean, dry surface with enough room for your clippers, comb, spray bottle and towels, and a place to hang your clippers and cape.
- **Starter:** a stable chair and a small table or tray.
- **Better:** an adjustable-height stool for you and a dedicated tool tray or caddy.
- **Pro:** a hydraulic barber chair, a full station with drawers, and a tool wall or holster.

> **Protect your body**
> Bad posture causes back, neck and wrist problems over time. Adjust the client's height so you work with relaxed shoulders, and take short stretch breaks.

16. Mannequin Head for Practice

A mannequin head lets you practice clipper control, fades, scissor work and even razor strokes without a live client. Practice here until your hands know the movements.

- **What to look for:** real or high-quality synthetic hair that is thick enough to cut, a stable clamp or tripod, and enough hair length for fade practice.
- **Starter:** a basic head with synthetic hair and a table clamp.
- **Better:** a head with thicker, more realistic hair that behaves like a real scalp under the clippers.
- **Pro:** a head with realistic, replaceable hair or skin layers for razor and fade work.

Use the same sanitizing habits on practice heads that you would on clients. It builds good routines.

17. Gloves

Gloves protect you and the client during razor work, when there is a risk of blood, and while handling chemicals such as bleach and color.

- **Materials:** nitrile gloves suit most uses and avoid latex allergies; vinyl gloves can work for light tasks.
- **What to look for:** a snug fit, enough thickness for chemical work, and a size that does not tear when you flex your hand.
- **Starter:** a box of disposable nitrile gloves in your size.
- **Better:** a thicker nitrile glove for color and bleach work.
- **Pro:** multiple sizes and types stocked for different services.

Wash your hands before putting on gloves and after taking them off. Change gloves between clients and whenever they tear.

18. Towels and Hot Towel Setup

Towels are one of the most overlooked parts of a barber's kit. You need clean towels for every client.

- **Everyday towels:** absorbent cotton towels for neck, face and wiping tools; buy more than you think you need so you can rotate.
- **Hot towel:** a warm, damp towel placed on the face before a shave opens the pores, softens the beard and relaxes the client.
- **Hot towel cabinet or steamer:** a dedicated warming unit gives consistent results; at home, a clean wet towel warmed in a microwave-safe setup and tested carefully can work.
- **Starter:** six to ten cotton towels.
- **Better:** a larger stack and a laundry routine, plus a small towel warmer.
- **Pro:** a dedicated hot towel cabinet and a stock of towels sorted for clean and used.

> **Test the temperature**
>
> Always test a hot towel on your own inner wrist before placing it on a client's face. It should be comfortably warm, never hot enough to burn. Wash towels with detergent and dry them fully after every use.

19. Lighting

You cannot blend a fade you cannot see. Good lighting shows shadows, uneven lines and missed spots.

- **What to look for:** bright, even, daylight-balanced light of around 5000 K that shows true color and skin tones, without harsh glare or deep shadows.
- **Starter:** a bright, adjustable desk or floor lamp placed to the side of the head.
- **Better:** two lights, one from each side, or a ring or panel light for a more even field.
- **Pro:** a well-planned station with overhead lighting and mirror lighting that removes shadows.

When checking a blend, move the light and look from several angles; a fade that looks even under one light may show patches under another.

The Starter Kit Checklist

This is the lean list for learning the course techniques. Buy the essentials first and add the rest as you grow.

STARTER KIT

☐ Corded clipper with a full guard set (#1 to #8)

☐ Basic trimmer with an adjustable blade

☐ Barber comb, fade comb and flat top comb

☐ Cutting scissors (around 5.5 to 6 inches)

☐ Cape and a roll of disposable neck strips

☐ Spray bottle (water only, labeled)

☐ Neck duster brush

☐ Clipper oil and a cleaning brush

☐ Salon-grade disinfectant spray and a soak container

☐ Disposable nitrile gloves

☐ Shavette with a box of single-use blades and a small sharps container (when you are ready for razor work)

☐ Clean towels (six to ten)

☐ Hand mirror

☐ Mannequin head with a clamp for practice

☐ Good adjustable lighting

☐ Basic aftershave and one styling product

Intermediate Kit

Once you cut regularly and have the basics down, these upgrades give you more control, comfort and speed.

CATEGORY	UPGRADE TO ADD	WHY IT HELPS
Clippers	A cordless clipper alongside your corded one	Freedom to move around the head; faster fades
Trimmers	A second trimmer or a T-blade detailer	Sharper lines and a backup when one is charging
Shaver	A foil shaver	Smooth finish on bald fades and necklines
Scissors	Higher-quality cutting shears and one thinning pair	Cleaner scissor-over-comb work and blending
Guards	A matched backup guard set	Always have a clean set while one is disinfected
Combs	A rotation of each type	Swap in a sanitized comb for every client
Capes	A second cape and a chemical cape	Clean one always ready; protects clothes during color
Disinfection	A larger soak tub and wipes	Handle more clients with proper sanitation
Station	Adjustable stool or a basic barber chair	Better posture and height control
Lighting	Second light or a panel light	Fewer shadows; better fades

Pro Kit

A pro kit is built for daily professional use, where tools need to survive heavy use and quick turnarounds.

CATEGORY	PRO-LEVEL SETUP	WHY IT MATTERS
Clippers	Two to three clippers (corded and cordless) in rotation	One is always cool, oiled and ready
Trimmers	Two detailers or T-blades	Sharp outline work all day
Shaver	A precision foil shaver with spare foils	Consistent smooth finishes
Blades	Spare clipper blades and a sharpening or replacement plan	Keeps the cut crisp as blades wear
Scissors	Premium cutting shears plus a range of thinners	Precision on any hair type
Razor	A high-quality shavette or straight razor, with fresh blades for every client	Safest and cleanest closest shave

CATEGORY	PRO-LEVEL SETUP	WHY IT MATTERS
Sanitation	A complete station with duplicate tools and a labeled soak	Never reuse an unsanitized tool
Chair and station	A hydraulic barber chair, tool storage and a wall mirror with lighting	Comfort, posture and a professional look
Hot towels	A hot towel cabinet and a full towel stock	Premium service and consistent results
Lighting	Shadow-free overhead and mirror lighting	Perfect blending

How to Maintain and Disinfect Your Tools

Maintenance keeps your tools sharp, safe and reliable. Build these into a routine so they happen automatically.

After every client

1. Brush the hair off clippers, trimmers and shavers, then brush out the blade area.
2. Remove guards and place them in a disinfecting container; remove used blades and neck strips and dispose of them properly.
3. Clean combs and brushes with soap and water if soiled, then disinfect them for the full contact time.
4. Wipe the blades with blade spray or wash, then disinfect the clipper surfaces as the label directs.
5. Put a few drops of oil on the blades.
6. Wipe down the chair, station and any surface the client touched.
7. Wash your hands thoroughly before the next client.

Daily and weekly

- Wash or replace towels and capes; dry them completely.
- Empty and clean the hair-collection areas; sweep and mop the floor.
- Check blades for sharpness, rust, chips or bent teeth.
- Wipe and dry scissors, then oil the pivot lightly.
- Recharge cordless tools fully.

Monthly or as needed

- Deep-clean blades, following the manufacturer's directions; replace or sharpen when dull.
- Replace foil and cutter blocks on schedule.
- Have scissors professionally sharpened and checked.
- Check cords, plugs and batteries for damage.
- Review your local sanitation rules in case anything has changed.

If someone gets cut

Stop immediately, put on fresh gloves, apply gentle pressure with clean gauze, and use a single-use styptic or antiseptic product designed for this. Dispose of blades and contaminated items safely. Do not reuse anything that touched blood without proper cleaning and disinfection per your local rules. Seek medical attention for anything more than a minor nick.

How to Buy Used Equipment

Used tools can save money, especially for chairs, stations and mannequin heads. Some items are risky to buy used, so be selective.

Usually fine used

- Barber chairs, stations, mirrors and lighting, after a thorough cleaning
- Mannequin heads and stands
- Hot towel cabinets and steamers, tested before buying
- Corded clippers from a seller who can show them running

Be careful or avoid

- Razors, shavette handles with corrosion or a loose blade lock
- Foil shavers with dented foils or worn cutters
- Scissors with damaged edges or loose tension; sharpening may cost more than a new pair
- Cordless tools with tired batteries
- Combs and brushes, which are cheap enough to buy new
- Anything with cracked housing, frayed cords or rust

USED EQUIPMENT INSPECTION

☐ Ask to see the tool running and listen for grinding or rattling

☐ Check blades for rust, chips, bent teeth and uneven wear

☐ Test the cord, plug and switch

☐ Check the battery runtime on cordless tools

☐ Confirm replacement blades, guards and parts are available

☐ Check hydraulics on chairs for slow sinking

☐ Clean and disinfect everything before first use, whatever the seller says

☐ Compare against new prices so the saving is real

Suggested Budget by Stage

These ranges are rough, marked 'around', and meant for planning only. Prices vary widely by country, store, season and quality. Spend where it matters most first: a reliable clipper, a trimmer and sanitation supplies.

STAGE	WHAT IT COVERS	AROUND (USD)
Starter	Clipper, trimmer, guards, combs, scissors, cape, spray bottle, brushes, oil, disinfectant, gloves, towels, mannequin, lighting	Around 150 to 400
Intermediate	Add a cordless clipper, foil shaver, better scissors, second cape, larger disinfection setup, better lighting and a stool	Around 400 to 1,000
Pro	Add redundant tools, premium scissors, hydraulic chair, station, mirror lighting and hot towel cabinet	Around 1,500 to 4,000 or more

> **Prices vary**
> These are loose planning numbers. Used equipment, sales and regional differences can move totals a lot, and some places require specific tools or licenses that add cost. Treat them as guides, not quotes.

- Buy the starter kit first and learn with it for a few months before upgrading.
- Upgrade the tool you use most, usually your clipper or trimmer, before the rest.
- Put money into sanitation and blades before cosmetic extras.
- Keep a small reserve for replacement blades, oil, towels and disposables.

Shopping Checklist

Print or copy this list and tick off items as you buy them.

EQUIPMENT SHOPPING CHECKLIST

☐ Corded clipper

☐ Cordless clipper (later)

☐ Trimmer or detailer

☐ Foil shaver (later)

☐ Full guard set #1 to #8

☐ Cutting scissors

☐ Thinning or texturizing shears

☐ Barber comb, flat top comb, fade comb

☐ Neck duster, shaving brush, fade brush

☐ Capes and neck strips

☐ Spray bottle (labeled)

☐ Clipper oil, blade cleaner and cleaning brush

☐ Salon-grade disinfectant, soak container and wipes

☐ Shavette, single-use blades and a sharps container

☐ Aftershave and basic styling products

☐ Hand mirror and wall mirror

☐ Chair and station

☐ Mannequin head with clamp

☐ Disposable nitrile gloves

☐ Towels and hot towel setup

☐ Good lighting

☐ Local licensing and sanitation requirements checked

Next step

Start with the starter kit checklist, set up a clean practice space with good lighting, and begin the Fundamentals module with a mannequin head. Keep your tools clean, oiled and organized, upgrade only when your skills ask for it, and check your local licensing requirements before you work on paying clients.